

Mary, Star of the Sea School • General Music

Grades 4–5 General Music Syllabus

Mrs. Deeann Nishibun • SY 2026-2027

Mary, Star of the Sea School Mission

Nurture, Unite, Inspire. We are committed to nurturing each child's curiosity, uniting our classroom in respect and collaboration, and inspiring every student to grow in knowledge, faith, and wonder for the world around them.

2026-2027 Essential Question

"How can I model kindness, fairness, and humility like Jesus?"

Mrs. Deeann Nishibun

General Music Teacher • Grades K–3 • Mary, Star of the Sea School

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Emails are read/replied to during regular school hours.

Learning Goals & Objectives • Grades 4–5

Students will receive a comprehensive overview of subjects such as music theory, music history, and sight-singing, and will gain firsthand knowledge of music concepts through playing the ukulele.

Dance and movement songs will also be included for rhythm training and cultural purposes.

K–5 Scope & Sequence

K–5th Grade			
Q1	Q2	Q3	Q4
Creating and Performing		Responding and Connecting	

Kindergarten & 1st grade: Students typically begin by learning basic musical concepts such as clapping/playing on the beat, high and low pitches, fast and slow tempos, and loud and soft dynamics. They will learn simple songs and dances using free movements and imitation, play percussion instruments, and experiment with making sounds using their bodies or everyday objects.

2nd & 3rd grade: Students build upon their foundational knowledge and begin to develop more advanced musical skills. They will learn the elements of music through playing the recorder, learn and play in different time signatures, and sing solfege (do re mi so la). They will also explore different musical genres and cultures, and learn about the history and context of different musical styles.

4th & 5th grade: Students continue to develop their musical skills and knowledge through the elements of music. They will learn to play more complex instruments, such as the ukulele, and will have more opportunities for performing for others. They may also study music theory and composition, learning to create their own musical pieces.

Student Behavior

Students are expected to:

- Respect all people and property in the classroom at all times.
- Participate in all activities and come prepared for every class.
- Try their best.
- Follow the student code of conduct per the handbook.

If expectations are not met, we will take steps to help students reflect and improve:

- Gentle verbal reminders to support making better choices.
- Time during recess or lunch to review expectations and practice positive habits.
- A conversation with parents via email or phone to partner in success.
- A meeting with the principal to create a plan for moving forward.

Grading Policy

Class Participation

65%

- Bringing an instrument to class (recorder or ukulele)
- Classroom behavior
- Following rules and directions
- Active participation

Testing

20%

- Playing and written tests

Assignments

15%

- Completion of classwork

Contact Information

Email: dnishibun@starofthesea.org

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Empowered to Succeed, Guided by Faith